



Notes

Dec 3, 2025

Vin and Michael

Invited Vinnie Micciche Michael Donovan

Attachments 📎 Vin and Michael

Meeting records 📄 Transcript

Summary

Vinnie Micciche and Michael Donovan discussed Christina's proposed flat fee for newsletter work, which Michael Donovan found reasonable despite viewing the hourly rate as high. Vinnie Micciche expressed frustration with Michael Donovan's unfinished tasks and lack of clear communication regarding health issues or workload prioritization, contrasting this with Michael Donovan's focus on other projects like the Viconic website, which Vinnie Micciche wants Michael Donovan to stop working on until Perry provides clear direction due to Perry's frequent changes and complex requests. The conversation escalated to Vinnie Micciche questioning Michael Donovan's execution, leading to Vinnie Micciche suggesting that they need to separate, offering Michael Donovan a consulting role, and requesting Michael Donovan send a document detailing the constant changes Perry has made to the Viconic website.

Details

Notes Length: Long

- **Discussion on Christina's Proposal for Newsletter Work:** Vinnie Micciche initiated the conversation by asking Michael Donovan if they received Christine's email about Christina. Michael Donovan confirmed seeing the notification and needing to catch up on emails. Vinnie Micciche explained that they had replied to Sha and then replied again, noting that it was too late to talk to Christina since it

was late for them, and they just wanted to confirm Michael Donovan was "okay with it". Michael Donovan viewed Christina's proposed hourly rate as "a little on the high side," but considered the proposed flat fee for the newsletter to be reasonable. Michael Donovan felt that they were "airing on the side of caution" with Slack and indicated that the proposal seemed reasonable for the first month trial and workflow, noting that Christina has "pretty much all the workflow" (00:00:00). Vinnie Micciche pointed out that the rate was only "\$10 more an hour than what we were paying her to get a person that knows what to do," and Michael Donovan agreed it was "a huge relief" (00:04:35).

- **Vinnie Micciche's Frustration with Unfinished Tasks:** Vinnie Micciche expressed a problem in their working relationship with Michael Donovan that needed to be fixed, specifically regarding the completion of tasks. Vinnie Micciche stated that they do not ask for much or bother Michael Donovan frequently, but when they do request things, "it needs to start getting done". The frustration stems from Michael Donovan discussing things they are doing while seemingly ignoring Vinnie Micciche's requests (00:04:35). Vinnie Micciche emphasized that Michael Donovan needs to prioritize and deliver on the things they ask for. Vinnie Micciche mentioned telling "Z the same thing" about not asking for much and giving content, and the receipt of "different content" meant Michael Donovan was either "not reviewing it" or "not paying attention" to what Vinnie Micciche wanted (00:05:42).
- **Communication and Health Issues:** Vinnie Micciche stated that they had been trying to give Michael Donovan "a little room" because they knew Michael Donovan was "a little sick still". Michael Donovan shared that they had "dropped a freaking stone out my deck today" (00:05:42). Vinnie Micciche insisted that Michael Donovan needs to communicate, specifically by saying they are "f***** hurting," because Vinnie Micciche does not "have a crystal ball" and cannot know what Michael Donovan is dealing with. Vinnie Micciche compared this to themselves spending their whole career ensuring they did exactly what their bosses, customers, and employees asked, and felt they were not receiving that level of commitment from Michael Donovan (00:06:41).
- **The Viconic Website and Project Management Issues:** Vinnie Micciche mentioned dropping the Viconic website, stating they do not know what goes on between Michael Donovan and Perry, and that the latter no longer seems to care about it (00:06:41). Michael Donovan described Perry as "all over the map" regarding the website launch. Vinnie Micciche explained that they gave up on the

Viconic website after asking Michael Donovan for "anything by the end of the day" and not receiving it, initially waiting three days and then it becoming three weeks. Vinnie Micciche requested that Michael Donovan stop interrupting them, calling it frustrating. Vinnie Micciche elaborated that their stepping back from the Viconic site was due to conversations with Perry, who seemed to be the one "tossing it in different directions" ([00:07:33](#)). Vinnie Micciche decided that they did not need the Viconic website taking up Michael Donovan's time and advised them not to work on it until Perry gives "very, very clear direction". Michael Donovan recounted sending the site out after taking meeting notes, transcripts, documents, and content from conserver.io, applying "basic methodology copywriting methodology" to create a starting point because they were not getting "a clear anything from Perry". Michael Donovan admitted the site wasn't great but was a starting point ([00:08:21](#)).

- **Focus on Delivery and Avoiding Unnecessary Rework:** Vinnie Micciche insisted that Michael Donovan should focus on taking specific direction from the person requesting the work and delivering that, rather than trying to "recreate like some new way of doing things or some new engine or some new automations" ([00:08:21](#)). Vinnie Micciche viewed the issue as one of delivery and a tendency for Michael Donovan to "push back" with their own ideas, which Vinnie Micciche stated they did not care about. Vinnie Micciche noted that they do not see posts and, when discussing pages, they need to know what Michael Donovan is trying to accomplish. Vinnie Micciche challenged Michael Donovan's confidence in their marketing knowledge, suggesting that things are changing rapidly ([00:09:30](#)). Vinnie Micciche stated that their preference is for "velocity" and "speed," preferring to "fix me messes later," characterizing themselves as an entrepreneur trying to get a business off the ground, where mistakes are inevitable. Vinnie Micciche expressed concern about the lack of quick progress on the marketing side, describing it as "like pulling teeth" ([00:10:31](#)).
- **The Importance of Execution and Gratification:** Vinnie Micciche emphasized that they feel good when something is executed, posted, or done, even if it is not perfect, citing the ability to create an image quickly and Z's images as an example of being "just happy to have something done". Michael Donovan agreed that there is gratification and it is "positive activity". Michael Donovan then returned to the Viconic site, noting that Perry sent content that was merely a GPT document, prefacing it with "chat GPT knows me really well. I'm leaning into it," but then commenting that "this content's really dry" ([00:11:30](#)). Vinnie Micciche offered how they would respond to Perry: by being direct and stating they are

helping two businesses, they appreciate Perry having a marketing person to execute core stuff, but Vinnie Micciche does not "have time to think about what you're thinking about and try to create what's in your head" ([00:12:30](#)).

- **Perry's Requests for the Viconic Website:** Vinnie Micciche urged Michael Donovan to "defend yourself" against Perry's perceived view of Michael Donovan as incompetent. Michael Donovan revealed that Perry "wants the whole site to be video and videobased". Vinnie Micciche stopped Michael Donovan to enumerate the requests: video, "light colors, light version," and an "animated logo green" ([00:13:28](#)). Vinnie Micciche questioned where the video would come from, and Michael Donovan explained it was supposed to be from "some shoot that he's coordinating with whoever out there" ([00:14:18](#)). Vinnie Micciche noted that the light colors and animated logo could be done quickly, while the video was "coming," and suggested pushing back on Perry regarding the video source ([00:15:18](#)).
- **Communication Style and Complexity vs. Specificity:** Vinnie Micciche accused Michael Donovan of being unable to "articulate specific problems" and stopping them because they already knew where Michael Donovan was going. Michael Donovan countered that they can chunk it down but Vinnie Micciche "always tell me I'm getting overly f***** complex". Vinnie Micciche insisted that Michael Donovan gets "very detailed" and cannot explain things without getting "very long" ([00:15:18](#)). Michael Donovan stated that they had built the site "in record time" and outlined content and concept, but Vinnie Micciche interpreted Michael Donovan's response as defensive rather than problem-solving ([00:16:15](#)). Michael Donovan defended the complexity of the work, stating that code from a tool like lovable cannot simply be dropped and expected to function without a framework, styling, or design system. Vinnie Micciche redirected the conversation, pointing out they were talking about Perry, but Michael Donovan had shifted to discussing lovable and technical details ([00:17:12](#)).
- **Building the Viconic Site Multiple Times and Documentation:** Michael Donovan explained that they have built the Viconic site "several times" and gone "full circle" leading up to the launch. Vinnie Micciche asked why it was being built several times and requested documentation of the changes in decisions Perry had made. Michael Donovan mentioned a decision to do an interstitial before launch and take over the Strolid site. Vinnie Micciche requested Michael Donovan put together a document with a timeline of all the changes Perry had asked for, suggesting that Perry might be the problem, noting they have been talking about

the website since August ([00:18:05](#)). Michael Donovan agreed that Perry "changes his mind at a high frequency" ([00:19:07](#)). Vinnie Micciche suggested Michael Donovan should confront Perry about the six different iterations since August and the constant changes, proposing they hold off on work until Perry can provide a "clear understanding of exactly what you want, content, everything" ([00:20:10](#)).

- **Frustration with Unclear Expectations for Employees:** Vinnie Micciche used the previous situation with Z as an example, stating the only reason they didn't fire Z earlier was because Michael Donovan's expectations for Z were unclear. Vinnie Micciche noted that Michael Donovan gave contradictory figures for Christina's work, stating two or three pages yesterday and three to five pages on the current call, which Vinnie Micciche found "confusing" ([00:20:10](#)). Vinnie Micciche stressed that they need clear expectations for hiring someone, including what they are paid to do and if they are executing on it, and the lack of execution is the source of their frustration with Michael Donovan. Michael Donovan suggested they were experiencing "task saturation" and feeling overwhelmed by "a whole s*** ton of things that need to be done" ([00:21:29](#)).
- **Michael Donovan's Feelings of Distrust and Lack of Confidence:** Michael Donovan recounted a workflow document Vinnie Micciche sent regarding Z, which outlined Michael Donovan as Z's coach. Michael Donovan interpreted this as an indication of "no trust or confidence in my knowledge, skills or ability" because they were "removed from the approval" and had "nothing to do with the strategy" ([00:22:31](#)). Vinnie Micciche denied any dramatic intent, claiming they were only trying to give Z direction, which Z lacked, and reminded Michael Donovan that Vinnie Micciche was the one who fired Z based on expectations that were not met. Michael Donovan asserted that they brought up concerns about Z over a month ago, the week after the offsite. Vinnie Micciche stated that Michael Donovan could not articulate specific things they wanted Z to do three weeks ago, leading to Vinnie Micciche's frustration ([00:23:52](#)). Michael Donovan claimed the job description and Notion contained the specific tasks. Vinnie Micciche stated that Michael Donovan could have documented Z's failures and requested Z be fired, but Michael Donovan said they brought it up to Natalie, Joe, and Vinnie Micciche. Vinnie Micciche initially delayed firing Z due to worry about Michael Donovan oversaturating Z with too many things, leading Vinnie Micciche to chunk down Z's tasks ([00:24:36](#)).

- Z's Dismissal and Management Philosophy:** Vinnie Micciche recounted the conversation with Z during the firing, where Z tried to blame Michael Donovan. Vinnie Micciche told Z that Michael Donovan was Vinnie Micciche's responsibility, and Z's work was Z's responsibility. Vinnie Micciche concluded that Z was "playing" and was gone, but the conversation had gone off track. Vinnie Micciche returned to the current issue, stating they are asking for things, Michael Donovan says they are overwhelmed, and Vinnie Micciche has "no idea" what Michael Donovan does all day. Vinnie Micciche requested a "high-level view" of everything Michael Donovan is working on and why it is taking so long, asking to prioritize and execute on one thing, like the social posts Michael Donovan promised that morning ([00:25:28](#)).
- Status of Current Projects and the Need for Deliverables:** Michael Donovan provided an update on social posts, stating they have "a couple weeks worth" in front of them and would send them for review with captions in a Google doc. Regarding the website, Michael Donovan is "working on getting the pages designed and built," expecting a proposal for the UI/UX, initially for 15 pages to ensure flow ([00:26:27](#)). Vinnie Micciche requested that Michael Donovan provide expected timelines for deliverables, noting that the website Vinnie Micciche built took "an hour". Vinnie Micciche stated the company cannot remain in the same position for three months, or go a month and a half without social posts, or have only one email campaign last month ([00:27:38](#)). Michael Donovan claimed they were spending "so much time" and could show Vinnie Micciche everything. Vinnie Micciche countered, saying "shame on you for not telling me how much time you're spending on all this," as Vinnie Micciche has no idea ([00:28:27](#)).
- Accusations of Being "Painted into a Corner" and Discussing Separation:** Michael Donovan felt they were being "painted into a f***** corner" and that Vinnie Micciche did not want complexity or details but now did. Vinnie Micciche insisted they were creating the corner. Vinnie Micciche then stated, "I think I need I think we need to separate," and suggested Michael Donovan could do "some consulting work" ([00:28:27](#)). Vinnie Micciche vehemently rejected Michael Donovan's claim of being threatened or put in a corner. Vinnie Micciche then instructed Michael Donovan to "work something up" to help with the remaining work so Vinnie Micciche could "move on," stating they cannot have a VP they do not "f***** trust". Vinnie Micciche justified placing Shauna and Natalie in the newsletter direction document by noting they were giving Z direction, not Michael Donovan, because Michael Donovan was not doing it or even looking at Z's

production ([00:29:09](#)). Michael Donovan claimed they were "excluded from the newsletter" ([00:29:55](#)).

- **The Z Document and Management Accountability:** Michael Donovan reiterated that Natalie called them the Wednesday before Michael Donovan was out sick ([00:29:55](#)). Vinnie Micciche refocused the discussion on why they put the document together, claiming Z and Michael Donovan had no clear direction. Vinnie Micciche claimed Z told them that the situation was "chaos" and that Michael Donovan "yell[s] at him" ([00:30:36](#)). Vinnie Micciche defended their management approach, stating they set expectations, held Z accountable, and Z is "gone". Vinnie Micciche again asked what Michael Donovan does all day without the "drama" and talk about being sick. Michael Donovan stated they are working on the website, "redesigning social," and creating a strategy that is not "slop going up" ([00:31:22](#)).
- **The Problem of Z's Independent Work on Social Posts:** Vinnie Micciche noted that Z doing work on their "f***** own" meant it "was not what I wanted" ([00:31:22](#)). Vinnie Micciche concluded that Z was not listening to Michael Donovan, or Michael Donovan was not involved. Vinnie Micciche questioned how Michael Donovan could look at the stuff Vinnie Micciche sends and then look at what Z was going to send out. Michael Donovan claimed they did not see the document Z produced, but Vinnie Micciche stated Michael Donovan got it on Monday ([00:32:05](#)). Vinnie Micciche clarified that Z sent them an approval link on Monday, but Vinnie Micciche needed to request access, indicating Michael Donovan was not paying attention to social posts until Wednesday afternoon when Vinnie Micciche emailed about access. Michael Donovan stated they called and texted Vinnie Micciche on Wednesday to catch up ([00:32:54](#)).
- **Insistence on Resolution and the Threat of Termination:** Vinnie Micciche expressed that the current conversation was stressing them out before a "very important company meeting". Michael Donovan insisted on knowing where they stand, stating, "I think you just fired me" ([00:33:39](#)). Vinnie Micciche proposed Michael Donovan spend the next few hours thinking about if the relationship is "healthy" and if they can "take direction" and "actually do what I'm asking you to do". Vinnie Micciche expressed that the relationship consists of constant arguments, dramatic answers, and having to wait 20 minutes for one answer, resulting in "no results from our marketing". Vinnie Micciche contrasted their own view as "black and white" with Michael Donovan's "very gray" perspective. Michael Donovan interrupted Vinnie Micciche, claiming Vinnie Micciche had fired

them and stated they were better off as a consultant ([00:34:25](#)). Michael Donovan argued that Vinnie Micciche wants a "checklist" while Michael Donovan is "building a f***** strategy," and claimed to have 181 pages of refined content "fully wrapped in schema". Vinnie Micciche dismissed this, stating none of Michael Donovan's efforts have helped the business, and Michael Donovan has been talking about redoing the work for months. Michael Donovan disputed the timeline, saying Vinnie Micciche's "perception of time is way off" ([00:35:05](#)).

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Michael Donovan will prepare a document outlining a timeline of all the changes Perry has requested for the Viconic site.
- ☐ Michael Donovan will send the social posts to Vinnie Micciche for review with the captions in a Google doc.
- ☐ Michael Donovan will provide an estimated timeframe for deliverables for the website pages design and build.
- ☐ Michael Donovan will work something up to help Vinnie Micciche with the rest of the stuff he is doing so Vinnie Micciche can move on.

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Transcript

Dec 3, 2025

Vin and Michael - Transcript

00:00:00

Vinnie Micciche: Hey, hold on a minute. I gotta finish something with my daughter.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: Did you get the email from uh Christine about Christina?

Michael Donovan: Yeah, I uh got to catch up on on a few emails. I did see the notification come through. Just pull it up quick.

Vinnie Micciche: you not use email?

Michael Donovan: What'd she say?

Vinnie Micciche: Did you not do you not use email?

Michael Donovan: No, of course I use email, man.

Vinnie Micciche: Well, I sent it Sha replied. I just replied again. Like, it's too late now to talk to her because it's late at night for her, but I just wanted to make sure you were okay with it.

Michael Donovan: Slack. H chasing content. Yeah. I mean, it's I think she's a little on the high side hour-wise, but I I also think the proposed flat fee is reasonable for the newsletter. I think we're airing on the side of caution um with Slack and yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. What?

Michael Donovan: It seems reasonable.

00:04:35

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, seems reasonable. first month trial uh workflow. She has pretty much all the workflow. Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: She knows what she's doing, buddy. You're getting You're paying \$10 more an hour than what we were paying her to get a person that knows what to do.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, it's a huge relief.

Vinnie Micciche: All right. Well, it's not took you all day to look at it.

Michael Donovan: Doesn't take hold handle.

Vinnie Micciche: Listen, I I gota I got to just say something. Hold on. Let me shut the I

think I figured something out between you and I. Yeah.

Michael Donovan: Oh, really?

Vinnie Micciche: That we need fix.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: And this is one of them. Um I don't ask you for much and I don't bother you too often, but when I ask for stuff, it needs to start getting done. That's all. That's where I'm getting frustrated is like you're telling me about all these things you're doing and I'm asking for stuff that I want done and it's almost like you ignore me and it gets me frustrated.

00:05:42

Vinnie Micciche: So, I just wanted to I just we just need to hammer that out because it's not that hard. I told Z the same thing. I don't ask for much. I'm giving content. The fact that I get different content means like you're not reviewing it. Um or you're not paying attention to what I want. Um, and you know that's not that's where my frustration comes from. You just have to start thinking about what I want and delivering on the things that I asked for. You can do whatever else you need to do, but when I ask for something, it's usually because I really want it.

Michael Donovan: Can you give me that? Yeah, Vin, that's fine. I don't have a a problem with with any of that.

Vinnie Micciche: Well, like I don't I know you're I know you're a little sick still, so I've been trying to give you a little room. Um and you got Oh, did you?

Michael Donovan: Yeah, I dropped a freaking stone out my deck today, dude.

00:06:41

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah. Like, dude, like, so you got to communicate with me, that's all. Just tell me you're f***** hurting. Like, I don't know. Like, I don't have a crystal ball. I can't tell what you're dealing with and what you're not dealing with. Maybe it's some kind of machismo f***** masculine thing that you don't like to share your problems with people or whatever, but like I I don't know what you're going through. I don't know what you're dealing with. So when I, you know, all I know is I spent my whole career making sure I did exactly what my bosses said and I did really f***** well and they all respected

me and also did what my customers asked and what my employees asked to the best of my ability. And and I don't get that from you. Like when I talk about listen, I know you got problem. You I've totally dropped the Viconic website. Uh because I don't know what goes on between you and Perry.

00:07:33

Vinnie Micciche: Um but he's care about it anymore.

Michael Donovan: Dude, he's I don't know, man. He's all over the map, man. He He want We're supposed to be doing this. It was supposed to be a launch. We were just trying to get it launched.

Vinnie Micciche: I gave up on it because I asked you one day to give me anything by the end of the day and I didn't get it. Um, three days went by. Now it's like three weeks since I you and I had that convers No, just listen.

Michael Donovan: Wait.

Vinnie Micciche: Hear me out. Stop you. And this is another thing. Don't cut me off. Like it's frustrating. I'm trying to get a point out.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: And so I've had conversations with him about it and he does seem like he's the one that keeps tossing it in different directions. So I backed off of it. Do you understand? That's not me requesting that. That's me saying, "What the hell is going on with the Viconic website?"

00:08:21

Vinnie Micciche: And it's also me thinking, "It's taking up a lot of Michael's time, and I don't need that." So, until he gives you very, very clear direction on what he wants, don't do anything on it.

Michael Donovan: So I sent the site out. I took pretty much all like what you were doing yesterday. I took all the meeting notes and transcripts and documents and conserved io. So I took everything applied some basic methodology copywriting methodology so it was a starting point because I wasn't getting just a a a clear

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Michael Donovan: anything from from Perry. And so is the site great? No. I mean, it needs it it needs a little refinement, but it's a starting.

Vinnie Micciche: No, no, no. See, that's that's the whole that's the whole thing I'm talking about. I don't give a s*** if it's me or Perry.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Take whatever direction specific and get specific on what he wants and then deliver that and move on. Don't try to rec No, no, no, but hold me up.

00:09:30

Michael Donovan: Yeah. But he

Vinnie Micciche: Hold up. Don't try to recreate like some new way of doing things or some new engine or some new automations and all that stuff. Just deliver what it is that they're asking you to deliver. Like, and that's the problem I have. It it's it's on the delivery and it takes and it's almost like you you push back on me because you have some other idea and I'm like, I don't care what your idea is. Like, I don't see any posts from, you know, that's just one example. I don't see any posts, for example. or when you talk about pages, I need to know what you're trying to accomplish and you make it sound like two to three pages. I'm I'm on chat GBT after you we had that conversation yesterday and and asking it to review our website or review you know competitors and you know I just do all kinds of different deep I don't ever think I know the answer. you seem to think you know the answer especially when it comes to marketing and I would challenge you on that because things are changing really really fast and you just like I it's not impostor syndrome with me I

00:10:31

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: don't want to learn how to code that's why I love lovable I don't want to learn how to write code for a web page now I can do it like without having to go to years and years of school now is it perfect now does it need to be tweaked yeah there's some expertise there I get it but my point is I like velocity I speed. I like getting s*** done. We can fix me messes later. That's who you work for. It's you like that, but that's who you work for, right?

Michael Donovan: But that's

Vinnie Micciche: I I run I'm an entrepreneur trying to get a business off of a off the ground. And we're going to make mistakes. You know what I've also found is no matter

how hard you try to not make a mistake, you're going to make mistakes and things aren't going to come out right no matter how hard. And I just don't see us getting things across the finish line very quickly on the marketing side. It seems to be like pulling teeth.

00:11:30

Vinnie Micciche: And I just don't understand. Like I can go in and create an image even if it's not perfect. Give it my, you know, color schemes and my fonts and all this other stuff and say, "Create me an image." And it probably would. And I'm sure that's what um Z was doing because his images weren't even that great. I was just happy to have something done. Do you do you feel that? Like when something actually gets posted or done or executed on, I feel good. I don't know if you feel that like I do.

Michael Donovan: Yeah. Yeah. Of course.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Michael Donovan: There's there's uh Yeah. That's called gratification, right? And and and it's uh it alleviates it's it's positive activity. Sum it up. just to give you, you know, the review that I had with Perry on the on the current version of the site. It was uh he he sent over I wouldn't even call it like site content.

00:12:30

Michael Donovan: It's it was just this, you know, preface of uh chat GPT knows me really well. I'm leaning into it and here's a GPT doc, which is fine, but then it's well, you know, this content's really dry.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm.

Michael Donovan: Okay, but it's sure.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. So, so just stop. Just stop right there for a second. Okay. The content's dry. He sent you the GPT stuff.

Michael Donovan: He sent me a GPT doc.

Vinnie Micciche: This is what I This is how I I I'm very direct and blunt.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: But how I would react to Perry is listen Perry, I'm trying to help on two businesses here. I got a lot going on. You think it's dry. I appreciate the fact that you you you know, you have a marketing guy in me that can help execute on some of the core stuff, but I don't have time to to think about what you're thinking about and try to create

what's in your head. That's what I would say to them.

00:13:28

Vinnie Micciche: I don't have I don't know.

Michael Donovan: Well, so I I mean Ben,

Vinnie Micciche: I can't read your mind. I don't have a crystal ball right now. I'm focusing on the automotive vertical. Like give like defend yourself because he thinks you're incompetent, frankly. I mean, he does. He doesn't say that those words, but he's not getting what he needs from you. And I don't know what that is, but you do. So, just f***** tell him.

Michael Donovan: he he he wants the whole site to be video and videobased and he wants to have Exactly.

Vinnie Micciche: Where's the video coming from? Let's just all No, no, no. Not exactly.

Michael Donovan: It's It's going to happen in in Colorado.

Vinnie Micciche: Stop. Let me finish. Video. What else? What else do you want? No, no, stop. I gota This is how I do things. Video. What else? What else does he want, Michael? Just You said video.

00:14:18

Vinnie Micciche: What else?

Michael Donovan: Uh, he Yeah. light light colors, light version.

Vinnie Micciche: Like colors. Okay.

Michael Donovan: Uhhuh. Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: What else? What else?

Michael Donovan: I mean, that that those were like the big the big asks and and it's whether right but oh and the animated uh logo green that he wants the green

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. Those are the biggest to me. It's not Yes. Because I say video. What type of video and where where am I going to get it from?

Michael Donovan: check animated which is fine but it's like prior to the launch I mean I've I've gone down this the

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. Listen, you just But there's three things that shouldn't be too hard to fix other than the video, which I don't know where you're going to get it from. And I would push that back on him. That's all I was going to say.

Michael Donovan: video. Yeah, the video is supposed to be some shoot that he's coordinating with whoever out there and yeah, but I've also been I've

00:15:18

Vinnie Micciche: Okay, great. So that's that's coming. That's coming. But the light colors and the animated logo can be done pretty quickly, right?

Michael Donovan: been trying to get anything done with, you know, with this guy consuming ridiculous amounts.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm going to add another No, but I'm add another Okay, but just just stop. Okay, but just stop because this is another thing you need to fix with me. You I I already know where you're going and I had to stop you because you can't articulate specific problems. You just said it. Hold on. You just said it. It's There's so much going on, but you can't tell me what that is. You can't chunk it down. You get No, you get very detailed.

Michael Donovan: I can chunk it down, but you always tell me I'm getting overly f***** complex. So, I don't want to get detailed or complex.

Vinnie Micciche: You get very detailed. You can't even explain.

Michael Donovan: I'm trying to simplify it for you, man.

00:16:15

Vinnie Micciche: You can't explain. No, you say it's all it's so much. You just chunked it down for me. Video, light, coloring, and animated logo. Those are the three things. It doesn't take It takes 10 seconds to say that. You can't explain that without it getting very long. That's what I'm trying to say. Like, I don't know. Just tell me what it is that that is overly complex.

Michael Donovan: Finn, I built I built the site, okay? I delivered it in in in record time before that site was even built. I outlined all of the content and the concept on the right.

Vinnie Micciche: talking about, Michael, where are we going right now? I'm trying to solve a problem and you're trying to defend yourself.

Michael Donovan: But what I'm I'm not defending myself. I'm just letting you know that this site has been.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah.

Michael Donovan: It's been built.

Vinnie Micciche: Get real get very specific with what you're about to say. Specific.

Michael Donovan: It's been It's been built and rebuilt and broken and then rebuilt again in record time.

00:17:12

Michael Donovan: And I I know I can Vin I really do appreciate the whole lovable. It's great that HTML, you can't take that and drop it and expect it to to function.

Vinnie Micciche: Mhm. Okay.

Michael Donovan: And you know, there's no framework to it.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Michael Donovan: No framework, no styling, no design system. It's not that simple. It really isn't.

Vinnie Micciche: I didn't say it was.

Michael Donovan: Okay. I just And and Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: I told you when I started when I when I showed it to you that I created code for a web page and built a page.

Michael Donovan: Well, so I'm talking about a website and I'm just trying to give you the context of the the site was originally built in kind of a blank slate.

Vinnie Micciche: That is perfect for me. I don't know what the details are involved.

Listen, I don't even You're talking about lovable right now. That's my whole point. We were talking about Perry and you and you're telling me you got all these Okay.

00:18:05

Vinnie Micciche: Well, give me the context first. How about that? No, but how about giving me the context first instead of going down these paths that I don't know where I'm headed?

Michael Donovan: Okay, I've built a ve the Vconic site several times and I have gone full circle on, you know, leading up to the launch.

Vinnie Micciche: My problem built sever I'm trying to fix a problem here, Michael.

Michael Donovan: It's moving the same pile of rocks.

Vinnie Micciche: I don't want to hear hear all your Listen.

Michael Donovan: Okay. Well, because the the decision the decisions made by by Perry.

Vinnie Micciche: No, listen. You built it several times. Let's chunk it down. Why? What is

the core problem here? Why are we building it several times? Okay. Can you document those decisions that he changed his mind?

Michael Donovan: Yeah, we were going to do an interstitial before launch and take over the Strolid site.

Vinnie Micciche: Go. I just asked a simple question. Can you document a timeline of all the changes that he's asked for?

00:19:07

Michael Donovan: Oh my god. Yeah, sure. I I can I telling it's pretty

Vinnie Micciche: Great. So, you put that together. Here are all the changes you've made, Perry. This is why it's taking so long. That's how I do things. Like, in other words, I can't figure out what the actual problem is talking to you. But again, if you if you show me if you show me that he's asked you for eight different iterations on over the last two months. I mean, it's crazy that it's we've been talking about this freaking website since August. I mean, maybe Perry's the problem. I have no idea.

Michael Donovan: It seems as though the like changes his mind at a high frequency.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay.

Michael Donovan: All right. Leading up to example week the week before.

Vinnie Micciche: I think what he's trying to say is he came in when he came in right he did not know what he told me we were going to be an infrastructure layer now he's building applications he wasn't even focused

00:20:10

Michael Donovan: Uh-huh.

Vinnie Micciche: on the BO industry now he is so things do change but you deserve that explanation and the way you ask for that explanation is by saying Perry we've gone through six different iterations since August.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: You keep changing your mind. I got Vin breathing down my neck because he needs stuff done. How about I just hold off on all this stuff until you come up with a clear understanding of exactly what you want, content, everything, and then I'll get to work on it. That's how I fix things. And then if he says that's a he might say that's a great idea. I don't want you spending time rebuilding and then building and then

rebuilding and building a site like that. And now I'm only using that as an example. When I asked you about what Z did a few weeks ago, the only reason I didn't fire him is because it was too hard for me to understand what you had for expectations for him. Yesterday you told me you needed Christina for two or three pages and on the call you said three to five.

00:21:29

Vinnie Micciche: That that's confusing to me.

Michael Donovan: If we're going to iterate, I that's all

Vinnie Micciche: No, but if I'm going to hire somebody, I want to know specifically what I can expect from them, what I'm paying them to do, are they doing it or not? When it starts getting convoluted, it's hard to manage it. The only way you manage is by setting clear expectations and making sure that things are getting executed on. That's why I'm having frustrations with you is because I don't know why we're not executing on stuff. And it could be that you have way too many things going on, you know? I don't know.

Michael Donovan: Vin. Yeah. When I'm feeling the impacts. Are you familiar? You ever hear of task saturation?

Vinnie Micciche: See, there you go. Where are we going with this conversation? It's just just explain to me quickly and simply what you're trying to say.

Michael Donovan: Yeah, it's easy. It's easy to get overwhelmed when there's a a whole s*** ton of things that need to be done.

00:22:31

Michael Donovan: All right. And and then, you know, just to give you my perspective, the Friday before I was out, I was out on Thursday, not feeling well.

Vinnie Micciche: Yep. Go ahead.

Michael Donovan: Knew why. came back Friday and and Z and Z was um you sent the document out which basically outlined me as his coach,

Vinnie Micciche: I I know the whole story. Yep. Yep. Here you go.

Michael Donovan: which also is an indicator to me that there's no uh trust or confidence in my knowledge, skills or ability and well then I

Vinnie Micciche: I have no idea what you're talking about right now, coach. Now, be specific. What What did I say that made you feel that way?

Michael Donovan: it it I didn't it was it was the the entire uh flow and process that I'm removed from the approval.

Vinnie Micciche: This is Don't get dramatic about it. Just tell me what we what I said that made you feel that way.

Michael Donovan: I have nothing to do with uh the strategy.

00:23:52

Michael Donovan: It wasn't even a strategy. It was more of a workflow.

Vinnie Micciche: I don't have no idea what you're talking about.

Michael Donovan: Vinn, it's the document you sent. I I mean, I don't I just read it.

Vinnie Micciche: You read way too deep into that. I'm trying to give I'm trying to give the guy directions. direction, which he had none.

Michael Donovan: He Okay, that's not true.

Vinnie Micciche: And B, guess what? Michael, I'm the one who fired him, not you. Okay? And I fired him based on that document. I fired him on based on I said expectations that he did not live up to. You could have fired him a month ago.

Michael Donovan: I brought that up over a month ago, the week after the the off site.

Vinnie Micciche: Done that. I asked you three weeks ago what you have him do. You could not spit it out like specific things that you wanted him to do. That's what frustrated me.

Michael Donovan: I have that that's in the job description.

00:24:36

Michael Donovan: I have it in notion.

Vinnie Micciche: Okay. So, what wasn't he doing? That's all you have to do is put a document together.

Michael Donovan: The only thing he was doing.

Vinnie Micciche: Hold up. Hold up. You put a document together and you say, "Here are the things I've asked him to do that he's not accomplishing and here's his job description. I want to fire him." I wouldn't say no.

Michael Donovan: Okay. Well, I brought it up to Natalie. I spoke to Joe about it and I brought it up to you on a couple occasions as well.

Vinnie Micciche: And the reason I time is because I was one I was worried that you

were you were oversaturating him with too many things to do.

Michael Donovan: It was definitely an issue, but

Vinnie Micciche: So I chunked it down to a few things that were very easy to understand. Explained to him how important it was. I explained it I had him repeat it back to me four times. And so yesterday it wasn't that hard to fire.

00:25:28

Vinnie Micciche: He wanted to blame everything on you. I I told him, "Michael is is is my responsibility. The work I asked you to do was your responsibility. And if you're going to sit here and tell me that you didn't get any work done last week because Michael is telling you not to do it, I don't buy it." Is what I told He knows. He knows exactly what he was doing. He He's playing. He Anyway, whatever. We're way off track.

Michael Donovan: where I I Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: All I'm trying to say is I'm asking for stuff. You're saying you're overwhelmed. I don't know what you do all day. I don't I have no idea.

Michael Donovan: What I'm What specifically would you like to know about the yesterday or today or Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: Well, you're the one. No. No, no, no, no, no. It's not yesterday, today. Can't you give me like a highle view of everything that you're working on and why it's taken so long?

00:26:27

Vinnie Micciche: And can we execute on can we prioritize and execute on one thing like social posts that you told me this morning you would have out today which I'm waiting for? Because when I tell people I'm going to do something, I do it. That's all. And I just want to know what I can expect.

Michael Donovan: Yeah.

Vinnie Micciche: What I And if it's too you got too much going on, you're overwhelmed.

Michael Donovan: So, no, I'm I'm I'm a Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: What are you doing? Maybe we cut back on some things.

Michael Donovan: So, as far as the social posts go, I'm I have them right in front of me. Couple weeks worth. I'm gonna send them over to you for review with the captions. I'll put them in the Google doc or whatever. Um the website I am working on getting the

pages designed and built. I'm expecting that proposal. Uh you know the the UI and UX is definitely a thing. uh initially for 15 pages, right? The the homepage design to have flow.

00:27:38

Michael Donovan: Now, if you want me to use something from lovable as a point of reference, that's fine. But I it's fine if that's what you want to do.

Vinnie Micciche: Let me Yeah, it's fine.

Michael Donovan: I'm not super

Vinnie Micciche: I I can't have this conversation more. I have a company meeting in a half an hour where I have to talk to everybody and I can't be getting myself all worked up. Okay. I just can't. I want execution. I built that in an hour. You're telling me it's going to take a s*** ton more time. Great. How much more time is that? When can we expect deliverables? That's how you need to work with me. It's that simple.

Michael Donovan: Okay. All right.

Vinnie Micciche: It can't be three months from now, we still are in the same f***** position we were in three months ago. That's my problem.

Michael Donovan: Okay.

Vinnie Micciche: It can't be a month and a half without social posts.

00:28:27

Vinnie Micciche: It can't be uh one email campaign last month because I asked for it and none in the month before and none the month before that. like we got to start doing things.

Michael Donovan: So, Vin, I was spending so much time and I could walk you through and show you everything and I'm sure it would make sense to you, Vin.

Vinnie Micciche: Shame on you for telling me. Shame on you for not telling me how much time you're spending on all this because I don't know. I have no idea how much time you're spending on anything.

Michael Donovan: Like, okay, so I'm getting painted into a f***** corner, Vin.

Vinnie Micciche: All I know is I'm painting you.

Michael Donovan: That's what you're doing, man. You don't want it complex. You don't want details.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm painting you.

Michael Donovan: Now you want details, but I can't.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm creating you into a corner.

Michael Donovan: Vinn, that's what it feels like. Yeah, it it really does.

Vinnie Micciche: Michael, I don't think I think I need I think we need to separate.

00:29:09

Michael Donovan: I I want to give you the information. So, I didn't say you're threatening me.

Vinnie Micciche: Um I maybe you can do some consulting work for me, but I can't have you telling me I'm threatening you. You're a VP for Christ. Yes, you just did. I'm putting you in a corner.

Michael Donovan: No, there you go.

Vinnie Micciche: So, do me a favor. Do me a favor, right? work something up where you can help me with the rest of the stuff you're doing so I can move on because I can't have that from a VP of I I can't have somebody I don't f***** trust.

Michael Donovan: and a VP from a VP.

Vinnie Micciche: No, I can't. Yeah. Yeah. And let me read it back to you, okay? Because um Shauna and Natalie both told me that they were given Z direction on the newsletter. Okay. Not you. So that's why I put their names in there. I'm giving him direction as you saw last week on the social post back and forth on what I liked and didn't like.

00:29:55

Vinnie Micciche: So that's why I put myself into that role because you weren't doing it.

Michael Donovan: No, that's not true.

Vinnie Micciche: You weren't even looking at what he was producing. You weren't looking at what he was producing. Michael, you don't want to manage people.

Michael Donovan: Ben, I was excluded from the newsletter.

Vinnie Micciche: You're talking about being a coach for coaching.

Michael Donovan: Natalie called No, I'm What are you talking about?

Vinnie Micciche: Like you're trying to blame me for for that document. At least I gave him something. Stuff wasn't getting done. She asked me straight out, I'm not a marketing person. Should I be the one giving him direction on what to do?

Michael Donovan: Who? Natalie Vinn the the freaking Wednesday before I I was out for

the day.

Vinnie Micciche: Yeah, she told me that.

Michael Donovan: Sick. Okay, we had Friday.

Vinnie Micciche: Forget about that. Forget about I'm not talking about that.

Michael Donovan: Hold on then.

Vinnie Micciche: You're starting. See, you're dragging me into some other f***** realm there.

00:30:36

Michael Donovan: I'm not dragging you into it.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm talking about why I put that document together.

Michael Donovan: That's when we were doing the newsletter.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm telling you why I put that document together.

Michael Donovan: Z and I had a standing Friday meeting, man.

Vinnie Micciche: and put it together so we had some clear direction which he didn't have from my conversation with you or him and I gave him No, he didn't.

Michael Donovan: Who? Z. Right.

Vinnie Micciche: All he told me about the last time I spoke to him was it's chaos and all you do is yell at him. I'm just telling you what he said.

Michael Donovan: Right.

Vinnie Micciche: So, I put that together to give him some direction. And guess what? It worked because you were right and he's no longer with us.

Michael Donovan: Right.

Vinnie Micciche: But I did it the right way.

Michael Donovan: And neither am I. You're f***** You want to

Vinnie Micciche: I did it the right way. I had conversations with him that were documented with Natalie. I have a document that explains exactly what I wanted him to do, which he didn't do.

00:31:22

Vinnie Micciche: And so, he's gone. That's how you manage. You set expectations and you hold him accountable to it. And you're saying, "I'm trying to paint you in a corner. I don't know what you do all day long, Michael. I'm not painting you in a corner. I need to

know what you do all day long without having to hear all the drama and talk about how you were out sick. I know you were out sick. What is it that you have on your plate? You can't even explain it in five words or less or or listening last week stuff he he drew up.

Michael Donovan: Vin, I have Yeah, I'm I'm working on the website. I'm now redesigning social and coming up with a strategy where it's not slop going up, but it's addressing everything that you wanted with the storytelling and the evolution of He did that on his f***** own.

Vinnie Micciche: You weren't doing that because it was not what I wanted.

Michael Donovan: But everything before that, I didn't tell him to do that, man.

00:32:05

Vinnie Micciche: I know. Exactly. Exactly. He did it on his own. Exactly.

Michael Donovan: I was not the one that was Oh my god, man.

Vinnie Micciche: No, he's that. It's exactly right. He's not listening to you or you're not you're not even involved.

Michael Donovan: Ben, what is the the process at that point?

Vinnie Micciche: You weren't even involved in that is way way I looked at it.

Michael Donovan: Finn, he didn't Oh my god, man.

Vinnie Micciche: Some of Ken stuff I imagine you can't possibly look you can't possibly look at the com the stuff I send you and then look at what he was going to send out last week.

Michael Donovan: You gave him Hold on. You provided these documents.

Vinnie Micciche: You got it on Monday.

Michael Donovan: I didn't see it.

Vinnie Micciche: Hold up. You got it on Monday. I didn't see it until Wednesday afternoon because I didn't have access to it to that.

Michael Donovan: You didn't have access to what? The only thing that I received a notification on was access to the original doc that you provided that I uploaded to the Google Drive.

00:32:54

Michael Donovan: And I think it's in there twice.

Vinnie Micciche: No, no, no. He sent me an approval with a link. I clicked on it. It said

request access. I requested access and I emailed him and said I need access.

Michael Donovan: Okay. I'm just letting you know that that I received

Vinnie Micciche: It was his creative. It was his content. Don't listen, Michael. I'm pretty clear on what I did and I sent you the email when I asked for access on Monday, which means that Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, you weren't even paying attention to social posts last week because you didn't find out till Friday. So, he's not asking you for for any guy Wednesday.

Michael Donovan: I didn't find out till Friday. I f***** called and texted you on Wednesday.

Vinnie Micciche: I'm sorry, Wednesday. Wednesday afternoon. Okay. So, it was Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday.

Michael Donovan: Okay. And yeah, Vin and I was getting caught up.

Vinnie Micciche: We didn't have one, Michael. Yeah.

00:33:39

Michael Donovan: Okay. Natalie had Natalie had had still this um

Vinnie Micciche: This is exactly the conversation I for my very important company meeting. You know what I'm saying? I don't need to be all riled up before I talked to every employee, which I don't ask you to do. I had asked you to talk to one employee. It was Z. And it it seemed like you didn't he didn't even want to talk to you on Wednesday. He wouldn't even get on a call with you.

Michael Donovan: I was on a call with him Vin. Okay. And I wanted to get out of the Slack huddle. so it could be documented because it was an ongoing issue, man.

Vinnie Micciche: It's okay. Michael, let's pick up this conversation and later on, okay? Because I I need to now try and I think we ask you a question.

Michael Donovan: Well, you know what? I I'm going to insist that I know where the f*** I stand here cuz I think you just fired me.

00:34:25

Michael Donovan: So, I guess figure that out and text me.

Vinnie Micciche: I give you something to think about for the next few hours. Is this a healthy relationship? This is all we do is f***** argue because you don't listen. You get dramatic on every f***** answer. I got to wait 20 minutes to get one answer. I just I

don't know where this is going. I'm getting no results from our marketing. We're not We haven't Michael. It It's all like black and white to me and it's very gray to you and I don't understand it. I'd be happy to pay you to finish off all the stuff you're doing if you want to leave, but you got to change.

Michael Donovan: No, Finn.

Vinnie Micciche: You got to stop being who you are.

Michael Donovan: You just f***** fired me, man. I'm like, I can't be f***** threatened.

Vinnie Micciche: No, no, no, no. Just let me finish the sentence.

Michael Donovan: You just told me we're going to part ways.

Vinnie Micciche: Let me finish the sentence.

00:35:05

Michael Donovan: It's better you be a consultant.

Vinnie Micciche: I said, let me finish the sentence.

Michael Donovan: f***.

Vinnie Micciche: Let me finish the sentence. I just if you let me f***** talk once in a while, then you would have heard the end of it.

Michael Donovan: Really?

Vinnie Micciche: I said, you need to spend the next two hours thinking about if this is a healthy relationship and you can take direction from me and actually do what I'm asking you to do. And if you're gonna if this is going to continue in this type of ad adverse relationship, why would we want both want to continue on this? Why why would you want to be involved in this? We don't you it's like we're like oil and water. I want f***** answers and you give me it's all gray.

Michael Donovan: No, you want you want this like checklist that I'm building a f***** strategy for you. We have 181 pages. You have refined content fully wrapped in schema.

Vinnie Micciche: Oh my god.

Michael Donovan: You don't even want the details, but now you want the f*** it. I'll think about

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